

Athdara ("Eight-Doored Pavilion")

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1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Maharaja Ranjit Singh
- Built in: Sikh period
- Cost: Not documented
- Built for: Ranjit Singh's kacheri (court of justice)

2. Construction Details

- Materials: Marble and red sandstone, reportedly repurposed from earlier Mughal structures
- Decoration: Motifs and frescoes
- Location: Near the Sheesh Mahal, within the Shah Burj Quadrangle

3. Historical Background

- That its marble and sandstone were reportedly repurposed from earlier Mughal buildings is a telling detail about how the Sikh court related to the fort's Mughal fabric - not simply preserving it, but actively recycling its materials into new structures serving new purposes.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- The pavilion's name comes directly from its architecture - "Ath" (eight) + "dara" (doored) - referring to its eight-doorway design.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Where Mughal marble once framed an emperor's private apartments, Ranjit Singh's court now hears legal disputes instead - the same stone, quite possibly, repositioned to serve an entirely different kind of authority.